MIL-C-22652(Wep)
12 September 1960
SUPERSEDING
NAVORD OS 9896
25 January 1960

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGE, ACTUATOR, MARK 25 MOD 0

This specification has been approved by the Bureau of Naval Weapons, Department of the Navy.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification governs the manufacture, assembly and preparation for delivery of the Mk 25 Mod 0 actuator cartridge and the methods of inspection and tests upon which product acceptance will be based.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications, standards, drawings, and publications of the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-D-21625	- Design and Evaluation of Cartridges for Cartridge Actuated Devices
MIL-P-749	- Primers, Percussion for Small Arms Ammunition

FSC 1375

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STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	- Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-414	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Variables for Percent Defective

DRAWINGS

BUREAU OF NAVAL WEAPONS

LD 537886	- Cartridge, Actuator, Mk 25 Mod 0, List of Drawings, Specifications, etc.
LD 537889	- Container, Inner, for Cartridge, Actuator, Mk 25 Type, List of Drawings, Specifications, etc.
LD 537890	- Container, Outer, for Cartridge, Actuator, Mk 25 Type
LD 491821	- Test Set, Leak, Mk 328 Mod 0, List of Drawings, Specifications, etc.

ORDNANCE CORPS OF THE ARMY

Ord. Dwg. No. B7645332	- Primer, 72M
Ord. Dwg. No. B7553221	- Pin, Firing cal. 30, cal. 30 Carbine, cal. 45 and cal. 50

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PUBLICATIONS

BUREAU OF NAVAL WEAPONS

OP 5	- Ammunition Ashore (This Publication is for the exclusive use of the Government Inspector. It is not to be furnished to bidders or contractors)
OP 400	- General Instructions for the Design, Manufacture and Inspection of Naval Ordnance Equipment
NAVORD OD 5823	- Sensitivity Test of Primers and Detonators

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. - The following document forms a part of this specification. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids shall apply.

CODE OF FEDERAL REGULATIONS

49 CFR 71-78	- Transportation, Interstate Commerce Commission, Explosives and Other Dangerous Articles

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C. Orders for the above publication should cite the latest edition and supplements thereto.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General. -

3.1.1 The Mk 25 Mod 0 Actuator Cartridge shall be manufactured in accordance with Bureau of Naval Weapons List of Drawings LD 537886 and all documents listed thereon.

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3.1.2 The requirements and procedures of OP 400 shall be adhered to wherever applicable.

3.1.3 Unless otherwise specified by the procuring agency, a pilot production lot consisting of 200 cartridges shall be required of the contractor. The provisions of 5.1.1.1 and 5.2.1.1 shall be applicable to the preparation and delivery of the pilot production lot.

3.2 Material. - All materials used in the manufacture of the Mk 25 Mod 0 actuator cartridge shall conform strictly to the specifications referred to on the respective drawings, unless specific approval in writing covering a departure therefrom has been obtained from the procuring activity prior to manufacture. When alternate materials or methods of manufacture are specified on the drawings, the bidder's selections shall be clearly stated in the proposal.

3.3 Primers. - The primers utilized shall be from lots manufactured within a year past. Only primers from a single lot shall be used in a lot of cartridges. Primers shall be in accordance with applicable section of MIL-P-749 and Ordnance Dwg. No. 7645332.

3.3.1 Primer sensitivity. - Sensitivity of the primers shall fall within the limits prescribed in 4.4.1.

3.3.2 X-ray. - All primers shall be X-rayed and screened for defects as prescribed in 4.4.2.

3.3.3 Weight. - Primers passing X-ray examination shall have weights as prescribed in 4.4.3.

3.3.4 Head and primer assembly. - The head and primer assembly shall not leak when tested in accordance with 4.4.4.

3.5 Charges. -

3.5.1 Weighing. - All propellant and igniter charges shall be weighed and the weights checked by another operator.

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3.5.2 Moisture content of black powder. - The black powder used in the cartridge shall have a maximum moisture content of 0.9 of 1 percent at the time of loading when tested in accordance with 4.4.5 and 4.4.5.1. Subsequent handling shall be conducted in a manner which minimizes moisture regain. Care shall be taken to insure that all metal bearing surfaces of the stock are free of black powder.

3.5.3 Smokeless powder. - Smokeless powder shall not be subjected to unnecessary handling or exposure to the atmosphere. Inspect for signs of decomposition as outlined in paragraphs 1308 - 1318 and 1322 of OP 5, Volume 1. The inspector should familiarize himself with Chapter 18 of OP 5 and conduct tests to determine that the smokeless powder used to load the cartridge does not differ appreciably from the condition as received. Only powder from a single lot shall be used in a lot of cartridges.

3.6 Cartridge inspection. - The complete cartridge shall be free of the visible defects noted in 4.4.6.

3.6.1 Weight. - There shall be no appreciable difference in weight of cartridges, see 4.4.7.

3.6.2 Leakage. - There shall be no leakage of air in the completed cartridge, see 4.4.8.

3.7 Coordination. - Completely assembled cartridges, manufactured in accordance with the applicable drawings, shall assemble with mating components of the firing mechanism without selection or fitting.

3.8 Ballistic requirements. - Cartridges from each production lot, selected in accordance with 4.4.9 and tested in accordance with 4.4.9.2, shall fulfill the requirements of 4.4.9.3.

3.8.1 Misfires. - There shall be no misfires, see 4.4.9.3.1.

3.8.2 Hangfires. - There shall be no hangfires, see 4.4.9.3.2.

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3.9 Additional tests. -

3.9.1 Pilot production lot. - Cartridges of the pilot production lot shall be tested in accordance with applicable sections of MIL-D-21625.

3.9.2 Changes in propellant lot. - Whenever changes occur in the propellant lot validity of the charge determination shall be verified by performing the test prescribed in 4.4.11.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Sampling. - Unless otherwise specified, and when applicable, the sampling plans and procedures used by the government inspector in the determination of the acceptability of products submitted by a supplier for government inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions of MIL-STD-414 or MIL-STD-105, whichever applies. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, order, or requisition all samples for test purposes shall be provided at the expense of the contractor.

4.2 Lots. -

4.2.1 Inspection lot. - As applied to government inspection of units of product, the term "lot" shall mean "inspection lot", i.e., a collection of units of product used as a basis for government inspection. Unless otherwise specified, the number of units of product in "inspection lots" shall be as determined by the government inspector and may differ from the quantity designated in the contract or order as a lot for production, shipment or other purpose.

4.2.2 Pilot production lot. - Before entering into quantity production, a pilot production lot of 200 cartridges shall be delivered by the contractor to the procuring activity, for test. These cartridges shall be manufactured by the same procedures and at the same location proposed by the contractor for the execution of the contract. When a pilot production lot is received which complies with all cartridge tests and sampling requirements of this document, the applicable drawings and MIL-D-21625 the contractor will be notified and authorized to proceed with production. When production under

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a new contract immediately follows the manufacture of satisfactory material by the contractor at the same location, the requirement of a pilot production lot may be waived at the discretion of the contracting officer.

4.2.3 Production lot. - The suggested lot size is 240 cartridges plus those required for all tests. Unless otherwise provided for in the contract all cartridges for test purposes shall be provided at the expense of the contractor. Cartridges of a lot shall be of consecutive manufacture. The production lot shall be used for delivery and identification of cartridges and is not necessarily related to the inspection lot defined in 4.2.1.

4.3 Inspection. -

4.3.1 Contractor's inspection. - Unless otherwise required by the procuring activity, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all tests and examinations to assure that the Mk 25 Mod 0 Actuator Cartridge delivered to the Government are in full accordance with all applicable requirements. In addition the contractor is required to maintain records of all tests and examinations performed and to make these records available to the Government representative upon request.

4.3.1.1 Gages. - The contractor shall provide himself with whatever gages are necessary and adequate to insure that the material to which this specification applies will meet the dimensional requirements shown on the applicable drawings. If so stipulated in the contract, order or requisition, the procuring activity will furnish drawings of pertinent Navy Final Inspection Gages for guidance in the design of the contractor's inspection gages. However, such procedure shall not serve to relieve the contractor of his responsibility in the design and manufacture of such gages as may be required for the satisfactory fulfillment of the contract requirements, but is intended to facilitate acceptance of all components and assemblies by Navy Final Inspection Gages.

4.3.2 Government inspection. - The Government representative will examine the contractor's records and processes and will witness or perform examinations and tests as are deemed necessary to assure that components and assemblies of the Mk 25 Mod 0 Actuator Cartridge are in accordance with all applicable requirements.

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4.3.3 Production and acceptance inspection. - Production and acceptance inspection shall consist of the following:

Item	Nature of Test	Requirement	Test
Primer	Sensitivity	3.3.1	4.4.1
Primer	X-ray	3.3.2	4.4.2
Primer	Weight	3.3.3	4.4.3
Head and Primer Assembly	Leakage	3.3.4	4.4.4
Charges	Weighing	3.5.1	
Black Powder	Moisture Content	3.5.2	4.4.5
Smokeless Powder	Condition	3.5.3	
Cartridge	Visual Examination	3.6	4.4.6
Cartridge	Weight	3.6.1	4.4.7
Cartridge	Leakage	3.6.2	4.4.8
Cartridge	Ballistic Test	3.8	4.4.9
Cartridge	Misfire	3.8.1	4.4.9.3.1
Cartridge	Hangfire	3.8.2	4.4.9.3.2

4.4 Tests. -

4.4.1 Primer sensitivity. - Sufficient primers shall be randomly selected from each lot and tested in accordance with NAVORD OD 5823, Appendix II (Run-Down Method). Fifty primers shall be tested at each 1.0 inch test height interval, using a tentative initial drop height of 7 inches or appropriate value as determined after a period of testing. Lot acceptance for the sensitivity test shall be based on: $\bar{h} + 5s$ shall not exceed 15 inches, and $\bar{h} - 2s$ shall not be less than 2.5 inches, where $\bar{h}$ is the average critical height and s is the standard deviation. However, if any primer fires at a drop height of 2.5 inches or fails to fire at a drop height of 15 inches, the lot represented shall be rejected. The test shall be conducted with a press-fit adapter having internal dimensions the same as the cartridge head. A 3.94 ± 0.02 oz. steel ball (1.1875 inches diameter) and a firing pin manufactured in accordance with Ordnance Dwg. No. B7553221 shall be used in the test set.

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4.4.2 X-ray. - Primers should be mounted in suitable grooved racks and oriented so that the most revealing exposure may be obtained. Pressure sensitive tape may be used as an aid in positioning the primers. Reject all primers that are questionable from any standpoint, especially for: missing or abnormally thin charge; charge broken, cracked, or porous; deformed, misplaced or cracked anvil, or other inert parts.

4.4.3 Weight. - Reject all primers which vary more than ± 0.50 grain from the average weight of 100 primers of a lot.

4.4.4 Leakage, head and primer assembly. - Apply 50 pounds per square inch air pressure to the primer side of each assembly manufactured before allowing the sealant to dry. Units which leak shall be rejected.

4.4.5 Moisture content of black powder. - Conduct at least one test for each cartridge lot or daily, whichever requires the more frequent testing, and such additional tests as considered warranted by variations in conditions or process. Samples may be collected at the site of loading or taken from cartridges just prior to the black powder being sealed in the container. Weight losses per booster charge shall be ascertained with an accuracy of ± 0.2 milligram. The presence of moisture in excess of the limitation of 3.5.2 shall cause suspension of loading until corrective measures have been taken.

4.4.5.1 Determining moisture content. - Enclose a sample in a tared container. Weigh and expose for drying at 95°C for 1.5 hours. Close the container, cool and weigh. The loss of weight is calculated as the percentage of moisture in the original sample. As an alternate method, allow the sample to dry to constant weight in a desiccator at room temperature.

4.4.6 Visual inspection. - Examine each cartridge produced under contract and reject for: dents, deep scratches, split or cracked lip in the crimped area, damaged or improperly compressed "O" ring, case bulged during crimping, burrs or sharp edges, particularly around the shoulder, or any other defects which may conceivably prevent entry into firing chamber or affect stability or resistance to moisture.

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4.4.7 Weight. - Each cartridge produced under a contract shall be weighed. Using the average weight, $\bar{x}$, determined from the first 100 cartridges produced under the contract, weighed to the nearest 0.1 gram, reject any cartridge falling outside the limits, $\bar{x} \pm 0.5$ gram.

4.4.8 Leakage. - Allow completed cartridges to dry at least 24 hours before test. Each completed cartridge manufactured under a contract shall be tested in a dry vacuum leak tester using a test vacuum equivalent to 26.5 inches of mercury (cartridge leak test set Mk 328 Mod 0 or equivalent). Indication of leakage shall be determined by observation of the height of the mercury column for a period of at least one minute. Any observable drop in column height shall be considered evidence of leakage. Leaking cartridges shall be destroyed or broken down for salvage of usable components.

4.4.9 Ballistic test. - The number of cartridges selected from each lot for the ballistic test shall be in accordance with the requirements of MIL-STD-414 at Inspection Level V and an AQL of 0.04 and shall be fired in accordance with the following test:

4.4.9.1 Test equipment. - The test equipment shall consist of the following items or equivalent:

Initiator M4 with adapter to fit Mk 25 Mod 0 cartridge	- Internal volume, with expended cartridge in place, 2.8 cu. in.

A suitable pressure transducer for recording pyrotechnic gas pressure in the terminal chamber fitted to output end of M4 Initiator.

4.4.9.2 Test procedure. - Cartridges selected in accordance with 4.4.9 shall be conditioned for 24 hours at a temperature of +70° ± 2°F and fired in the test equipment. No more than 3 minutes shall elapse between removal of the cartridge from the conditioning chamber and firing. A record of pressure versus time shall be taken for each firing. The test device shall be cleaned and be free from residue or cartridge fragments before each firing.

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4.4.9.3 Criteria of acceptability. - Acceptability of the lot shall be based on the following conditions:

Maximum Pressure - The lower limit of maximum pressure shall be L=1225 psi. The lot shall be acceptable if the quantity $(\bar{x} - L)/s$, when computed in accordance with Section B, Part 1 of MIL-STD-414 is equal to or greater than the acceptability constant (k) as taken from Table B1 of MIL-STD-414 at an AQL of 0.04.

4.4.9.3.1 Misfire. - The failure of any cartridge to fire shall result in rejection of the lot, unless such failure is plainly attributable to faulty test equipment or procedure.

4.4.9.3.2 Hangfire. - One or more hangfires shall result in rejection of the lot represented. A hangfire is defined as a firing in which the elapsed time between actuation of the firing mechanism and the first indication of output on the pressure-time record exceeds 0.050 second.

4.4.10 Retest. - There shall be no retests.

4.4.10.1 Test failure. - If test failure is plainly due to an assignable cause, excluding test cartridges, original test results should be discarded and the test reconducted with a new sample of 30 cartridges.

4.4.11 Change of propellant lot. - Whenever a change occurs in propellant lot, validity of the charge determination will be verified by testing over the temperature range from -65°F to +160°F. In such case, a ballistic sample of 60 cartridges will be required.

4.5 Test results. - Results of ballistic tests shall be forwarded to the Bureau of Naval Weapons and the procuring activity.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. -

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5.1.1 Level A. - In addition to the following, Level A packaging shall be in accordance with 49 CFR 71-78.

5.1.1.1 Inner container. - Two cartridges shall be packaged in accordance with LD 537889.

5.1.2 Level B. - Not applicable.

5.1.3 Level C. - Not applicable.

5.2 Packing. -

5.2.1 Level A. - In addition to the following, Level A packing shall be in accordance with 49 CFR 71-78.

5.2.1.1 Outer container. - Four inner containers as described in 5.1.1.1 shall be packed in accordance with LD 537890.

5.2.2 Level B. - Not applicable.

5.2.3 Level C. - Not applicable.

5.3 Marking. - Cartridge marking shall be as specified on Bureau of Naval Weapons Drawing No. 2164489 which is a part of LD 537886. In addition to any special markings required by the contract or order, packaging and packing markings shall be in accordance with 49 CFR 71-78 and MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. - The Mk 25 Mod 0 Actuator Cartridge was primarily designed for and will be used in the canopy unlatch actuator of the TT-1 aircraft.

6.2 Ordering data. -

6.2.1 Data cards. - Data cards, five inches by eight inches, printed as shown below, shall be furnished with each lot of cartridges. Two of these shall accompany the shipping ticket; three shall be forwarded to the Bureau of Naval Weapons; five shall be furnished to the government inspector; one shall be furnished NAD, Crane (Code 4100); and one shall be placed in each packing container.

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MK 25 MOD 0 ACTUATOR CARTRIDGE

Manufacturer _____	Dwg. No. _____
Spec. No. _____	Loaded by _____
Cont.No. _____	Reg. No. _____
Lot No. _____	No. in Lot _____
No. in Box _____	Date (Mo. & Yr.) _____
Primer Mfgr. _____	Primer Lot No. _____
h _____	s _____

Propellant Mfgr. _____
Propellant Lot No. _____

6.3 GENERAL SAFETY PRECAUTIONS. - The loading, assembly, and handling of explosives, ammunition, ammunition components, fuzes, detonators, primers, tracers, boosters, pyrotechnics, etc., and sub-assemblies thereof, involve hazardous operations and therefore require suitable explosives safety precautions. Use of this specification shall not be construed as to relieve the contractor or manufacturer of responsibility for the safety of his operations. Listed below are the minimum provisions which a contractor or manufacturer (loader) of the above items should observe in order to fulfill his responsibility for safety. At the Bureau of Naval Weapons, Navy Department, and other government plants, these provisions are mandatory. Such other warnings and precautions, pertinent to the operational effectiveness or safety during use or loading of the specified item, are included in the detail provisions of the specification.

6.4 All loading operations should be conducted in a neat and orderly manner.

6.5 Safe equipment and methods should be utilized for transporting and handling explosives and loaded parts. Where required, remote control barricaded handling equipment shall be used for explosives operations, such as mixing, pouring, weighing, charging, sifting, drying, pressing, casting, crimping, etc.

6.6 Personnel handling detonators, primers, delay elements, lead-ins, boosters, and related parts which effect functioning, should in so far as practicable, avoid using bare fingers or improper equipment in order to prevent damage, corrosion, or deterioration from perspiration or other contaminating deposits.

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6.7 The exposure of explosive materials and related parts should be so controlled as to minimize the absorption of moisture from the atmosphere or other sources during loading and handling operations.

6.8 All explosives and completely or partially loaded items should be stored in suitable storage magazines located in accordance with the American Table of Distances (ATD) or other applicable safety standards; and, while in process, in safety lockers and chests if in loading rooms, or in adequate ready or service magazines located in accordance with Intra-plant distances when outside of loading rooms. For Navy explosives loading plants, the provisions of the Armed Services Explosives Safety Board covering quantity-distance regulations for explosives, shall apply.

6.9 Proper care should be exercised at all times to protect personnel from accidents, fires or explosions, and to limit damage to equipment and loading areas. In this connection, the following precautionary measures should be observed:

6.9.1 Employ properly proportioned and properly located protective barricades, screens or shields at all required points.

6.9.2 Keep only minimum limited quantities of explosives and completed or partially loaded parts present at each stage of operation.

6.9.3 Keep explosives and explosive parts in approved covered receptacles with covers in place when material is not being taken out of or put into the receptacles. Where necessary, receptacles should be conductive to ground electrostatic charges.

6.9.4 Protect operations from electrostatic charges by effectively grounding all machinery, equipment, and fixtures; and, where necessary, employ suitable grounded conductive coverings for floors, work benches and tables, and workers' conductive shoes. Workers' clothing of a type to minimize the accumulation of static charges should be employed. Fabrics such as silk and nylon, which promote static generation should be avoided. Additional

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grounding devices such as grounded bracelets for workers should be employed where operations are conducted with items which are unusually sensitive to initiation by static electricity. Such items include initiating explosives, tracer mixtures, and low-energy type electric primers, detonators and squibs. The latter types of items should have the free ends of lead wires bared and twisted together, and be packed in relatively small groups wrapped in bare non-insulated aluminum foil or other uncoated metal foil. During assembly and processing operations such sensitive electric items should be short circuited by clips or other devices until installed with safety shunt in the final device. Additional precautions for these items should include mechanical shielding to contain or deflect fragments and blast, also electrical shielding of these items from induced electric currents generated by sources such as lightning, static, radiations from communications apparatus, radar, or high frequency heating apparatus, etc. Where necessary for safety, humidity (See para. 6.7) of work rooms should be increased, as required to lessen electrostatic effects without excessive moisture absorption.

6.9.5 Protect all explosive operations from effects of electric current originating from equipment such as soldering irons, heaters, switches, wiring, motors, lights, test instruments, etc., by suitable insulation, grounding, separation or shielding. Such electric sources may initiate explosives by heat, sparks, arcs, or by completing an electric circuit through an electric primer, detonator, or squib. Circuits may be inadvertently completed, for example, from a defective electric soldering iron through a grounded contact. All electric types of primers, detonators or squibs provided with wire leads should have the free ends of the wires bared and twisted together to short circuit each unit, except when in process of assembly into a finished item. Where practicable, removable short circuiting clips, or other devices should be employed during manufacturing operations involving electric primers, detonators or squibs.

6.9.6 Enforce, where necessary, the wearing of suitable safety footwear, gloves, goggles, respirators, and impregnated garments to protect personnel against burns, poisoning and associated industrial hazards.

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6.9.7 Allow no fires or exposed electrical or other sparking equipment, and little or no flammable material to be present in loading, handling and storage spaces. Enforce proper "Match" and "No Smoking" rules where necessary.

6.9.8 Enforce good housekeeping and maintain effective policing, inspection and supervisory methods throughout the loading area and surroundings. Employ effective cleaning methods periodically to minimize the accumulation of explosives or explosive dust and other contamination upon, and assure its removal from, floors, walls, ceilings, ledges, tables, benches, piping, and equipment or the items loaded; also, clean up any spilled material immediately.

Notice. When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any invention that may in any way be related thereto.

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